Stimulus Has Class

In our current code we are using the hidden CSS class to denote hidden status, and we are hard-coding the class name inside our controller. That's not really a big deal for a short class name that is unlikely to change, but it's better practice to not tightly couple the class name to the controller and allow for arbitrary CSS classes. Eventually, we'll want our controller to have more generic behavior.

Stimulus has a mechanism for this, where we can store the class name as a special data attribute. Essentially, classes are special cases of the values attributes. The name of the data attribute has the form data-<controllerName>-<descriptor>-class, and the value of the attribute is the name of the CSS class being described—typically you'd use a descriptor that describes the role of the CSS class. These class descriptors are usually added to the same DOM element as the controller.

What we do is use a special attribute to register the CSS class or classes in the DOM:

chapter_03/07/app/views/favorites/_list.html.erb

```
<section
  class="my-4"
  data-controller="favorite-toggle"
  data-favorite-toggle-visible-value="true"
  data-favorite-toggle-hidden-class="hidden">
```

Here we have a new attribute, data-favorite-toggle-hidden-class, with

- data
- The controller name: favorite-toggle
- A description of the role of the class: hidden
- class

As with targets, we have to declare the class in the controller and we get a getter and an existence property. Then we can use those properties in place of the hardcoded class.